Product Scanner

Decision Intelligence for Beauty Products – Final PRD (Candidate Assignment Version)

1. What Is This Feature?

The StyleCast Product Scanner allows users to scan a beauty product and immediately understand:

- What the product is actually designed to do
- Who it works for and who it does not
- What real customers consistently say about it
- Whether it is a good fit for them or not
- What better alternatives exist if it is not the right fit

This replaces fragmented research across TikTok, YouTube, Reddit, and review sites with one clear decision outcome.

2. The Core Problem

When users encounter a beauty product:

- They do not trust marketing or packaging claims
- They do not know if it fits their skin
- They turn to social media for validation
- Reviews are noisy, biased, and contradictory
- Time is wasted and confidence remains low

Why most existing solutions fail:

- They focus on AR, visuals, or shade matching
- They surface raw reviews instead of insight
- They fail to answer the most important question

“Is this product right for me?”

StyleCast reframes product discovery as a decision problem, not a visual problem.

3. Primary Use Case (Must Be Supported)

“I found this product. Tell me if it is right for me.”

All functionality must support this outcome.
Everything else is secondary.

4. Target Users

Primary Users

- In-store beauty shoppers
- Online shoppers browsing unfamiliar products
- Users with clear skin concerns (dry, oily, acne-prone, sensitive)

Secondary Users

- Beauty enthusiasts
- Time-constrained shoppers
- Users overwhelmed by social media reviews

5. Required User Flow (Order Matters)

1. Scan product (camera-first)
2. Product identification
3. Product intelligence summary
4. Initial outcome (non-personalized)
5. Optional personal questions
6. Updated fit result
7. Alternative product options
8. Optional try-on

👉 Scanning must never be blocked by onboarding or profile setup

6. Core Features

6.1 Product Scan & Identification (CORE)

Input Methods

- Camera scan of product packaging
- Image upload or screenshot
- Product name search (fallback only)

Must Identify

- Brand
- Product name
- Product category
- Variant or shade (if applicable)

Out of Scope (MVP)

- Batch scanning
- Receipt scanning

6.2 Product Intelligence Summary (CORE)

This must be a clear, structured explanation, not marketing copy.

Must Include

- Skin type suitability
  - Dry
  - Oily
  - Combination
  - Sensitive
- Finish and texture
  - Matte
  - Satin
  - Dewy
  - Heavy vs lightweight
- High-level ingredient intent
  - Hydrating
  - Oil-controlling
  - Potential irritation risk
- Repeatedly mentioned pros and cons
- Common deal-breakers

Example

- “Best suited for oily and combination skin”
- “May feel heavy on dry skin”
- “Strong fragrance frequently mentioned by users”

6.3 Real Customer Review Intelligence (CORE)

- Do not show raw reviews
- Do not embed videos

Instead, provide summarized intelligence derived from real customer reviews and creator content.

Must Include

- Overall sentiment pattern
- Repeated praise themes
- Repeated complaint themes
- Who tends to like it vs dislike it
- Why opinions differ when they do

6.4 Outcome States (CORE)

The system must clearly return one of the following:

- ✅ Good match
- ⚠️ Mixed match (with reasons)
- ❌ Not recommended (with reasons)

This is the most important trust moment.

6.5 Alternative Product Options (CORE)

Alternative options must appear at the bottom of the outcome page.

Purpose

- Support confident decision-making
- Not to promote brands

Rules

- **Show 2–3 alternatives**
- **Same primary purpose and function**
- **Similar key ingredient intent**
- **Clearly different price points**
- **Explain why each option may be better**

Examples

- “Same hydrating goal but lighter texture”
- “Similar ingredients at a lower price point”
- “Better suited for sensitive skin”

7. First-Time User Flow (CRITICAL)

Assume no user information at first.

Rules

- Always start with scanning
- Never ask personal questions before showing results

Initial (Non-Personalized) Result

- Product intelligence summary
- General suitability outcome
  - Example: “Generally works best for oily and combination skin”

Post-Outcome Personalization

Only after showing the outcome, ask:

“Want to see how well this fits you?”

Users may select:

- Dry
- Oily
- Combination
- Sensitive

No account required.
No long questionnaires.

Percentage-Based Fit (REQUIRED)

After selection, update the result:

- Show a fit percentage
  - Example: “82% match for oily skin”
- Explain what drives the score
- Percentages are relative, not guarantees

Example

- Dry: 45% (may feel heavy)
- Oily: 82% (oil-control praised)
- Combination: 75%

Outcome state may update accordingly.

8. Product Identification Accuracy (CRITICAL)

Accuracy Comes First

If the system is not confident, it must not guess.

❌ A wrong match is worse than no result.

Confidence Rule

- High confidence → proceed
- Low confidence → return Product Not Found

No “closest match” behavior.

Product Not Found State (REQUIRED)

Show:

- ❌ Product Not Found
- “We couldn’t confidently identify this product, so we didn’t make a guess.”

Allow:

- Retry scan
- Upload another image
- Search by product name

Do not:

- Substitute another brand
- Show intelligence for an unverified product

9. Test Images (IMPORTANT FOR CANDIDATES)

Test product images will be provided. Please check your email for the attached files.

Candidates must:

- Use the provided test images / can also use other test images
- Correctly return Product Not Found when matching fails
- Avoid hard-coding fake outputs

This is part of the evaluation.

10. Dataset Requirement (IMPORTANT FOR CANDIDATES)

A Google Spreadsheet will be provided as the dataset for this assignment.

Link: 🌐 Product Scanner PRD -- Dataset

Candidates must:
Use the brands and products listed in the Google Spreadsheet as the data input and source of truth
Base product identification on the brands and products in the spreadsheet
Not invent, scrape, or supplement products from external sources
Not replace missing products with “similar” products

If a scanned product does not exist in the provided Google Spreadsheet, the system must return: ❌ Product Not Found

Hard-coding outputs or bypassing the dataset will be considered a failure.
This is part of the evaluation.

11. MVP Scope

Included
- Product scanning
- Product identification
- Product intelligence summary
- Review intelligence summary
- Outcome state
- Alternative options

Excluded
- AR
- Video analysis
- Deep ingredient breakdowns

12. Evaluation Criteria

We are evaluating whether you can:
- Design an accuracy-first system
- Handle uncertainty honestly
- Separate general logic from personalization
- Explain reasoning clearly
- Respect user trust

👉 Returning Product Not Found when unsure is a positive signal
👉 Guessing is a fail

13. Core Product Truth (Non-Negotiable)

The Product Scanner's job is not to sell products.
Its job is to tell the truth about fit.
Trust > coverage
Trust > conversion

14. Ingredient Terminology & Explanation Rule (NEW · REQUIRED)

Most users do not understand technical ingredient terms such as
Ceramide, Niacinamide, Salicylic Acid, etc.
This rule is mandatory.

14.1 Ingredient Display Rule

Do not remove technical ingredient names
Do not show technical terms alone

Always provide a plain-language explanation alongside them

14.2 Correct Examples

❌ Incorrect
"Contains Ceramide"

✅ Correct
Ceramide (helps protect the skin barrier and prevents moisture loss)

Or
"Ceramide is included to help keep moisture from escaping the skin, which is especially helpful for dryness."

14.3 Explanation Tone Guide

Do not write like a research paper
Do not write like a doctor
Write like a smart friend explaining it simply
Focus on what it does, not how scientific it sounds

14.4 Why This Rule Exists

This requirement tests whether you can:
Truly understand users
Communicate clearly
Go beyond technical implementation
Build a system that is understandable, not just "smart-looking"
Ignoring this rule will be considered low product quality.

15. Final Reminder for Candidates

StyleCast Product Scanner is not about sounding intelligent.
It is about being accurate, honest, and easy to understand.

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